Rong Zhang

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Personal Website: https://rongzhang123.github.io/

Education

Texas A&M University *2021 - Expected 2027*

Ph.D. Candidate in Agricultural Economics

Texas A&M University *2019 - 2021*

M.S. in Economics

Major: Financial Econometrics

University of International Business and Economics, China *2015 - 2019*

B.A. in Economics

Major: International Economics and Trade

Research Area

Food Marketing, Industrial Organization, Agribusiness, Demand & Price Analysis, Market Structure, Welfare Economics, Labor Economics, Income Inequality, Energy Economics

Job Market Paper

Retail Scale, Product Assortment, and Price Competition: Evidence from the U.S. Yogurt Market (with Mengjie Li and Yvette Zhang)

Publication

Zhang, R., and Y. Y. Zhang. 2026. "**The Pink Tax: Price Discrimination, Product Differentiation, and Gender-Based Pricing in Consumer Packaged Goods**," *Southern Economic Journal* 1-17. https://doi.org/10.1002/soej.70068.

Working Paper

Rong Zhang, Song Zhou, Yvette Zhang, "**Assortative Marriage, Female Labor Supply, and Household Income Inequality in China**," Under Review

Rong Zhang, Lingxiao Wang, Wenying Li, Yvette Zhang, " **When Lipstick Effect Meets Engel's Law: How Do Households Reallocate Spending across Economic Cycles?**"

Research Report

"**Techno-Economic Analysis and Life Cycle Assessment of an Energy-Efficient Lignocellulosic Pulping Platform**" (in preparation), USDA-NIFA funded research project, collaborated with Michigan State University

Work In Progress

Rong Zhang, Yvette Zhang, "Marrying Alike, Needing Less? Assortative Marriage and Wealth Adequacy"

Rong Zhang," Powering AI: Data Centers and Electricity Market Outcomes"

Conference and Presentation

Russell Sage Foundation (RSF) Journal Conference

Scheduled Paper Presentation, March 2027

AEA Annual Meeting

Scheduled Paper Presentation, Jan 2027

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting

Scheduled Paper Presentation, Nov 2026

American Agricultural Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Conference

Paper Presentation, July 2026; Poster Presentation, July 2025

Chinese Economists Society (CES) North America Annual Conference

Paper Presentation, March 2025

Southern Agricultural Economics Association (SAEA) Annual Meeting

Paper Presentation, February 2026

Symposium for Agricultural & Applied Economics Research

Paper Presentation, April 2025 & March 2026

Food Health & Applied Group Seminar, TAMU

Paper Presentation, December 2024 & February 2025

Econometrics Study Group, TAMU

Paper Presentation, August 2025

Teaching Experience

Lab Instructor

INTA Capstone Research Course, Master of International Affairs Students

Teaching Assistant

AGEC 105 Introduction to Agricultural Economics

AGEC 625 Environment of Agribusiness (graduate level)

AGEC 350 Environmental and Natural Resource Economics

AGEC 440 Agribusiness Strategic Analysis

AGEC 325 Principles of Farm and Ranch Management

AGEC 431 Cases in Agribusiness Finance

AGEC 340 Agribusiness Management

Research and Work Experience

Department of Agricultural Economics, TAMU *July 2025- December 2025*

Research Assistant for Dr. Yvette Zhang

Department of Economics, TAMU *April 2021-April 2023*

Research Assistant for Dr. Li Gan

Department of Agricultural Economics, TAMU *January 2022-August 2022*

Research Assistant for Dr. Jean-Claude Bizimana

The Bush School of Government & Public Service, TAMU *December 2020-June 2022*

Research Assistant for Dr. Ren Mu

CoronaNet Research Group *June 2020 - August 2020*

Volunteer Research Assistant

China Development Research Foundation *May 2019 – September 2019*

Economics Research Intern

Grants and Awards

Research Assistantship, USDA-NIFA Grant, Summer & Fall 2025 & Summer 2026

Graduate Assistantship, Department of Agricultural Economics, TAMU, Fall 2022 - Spring 2025

Graduate Scholarship, Department of Economics, TAMU, Fall 2019 – Spring 2021

Travel Grant, Graduate Students' Association (GSA), TAMU, Spring & Summer 2025, Summer 2026

Service

Journal Referee, Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy, 2026

Technical Support, SAEA Annual Meeting, 2026

Treasurer, Graduate Student Organization, TAMU, 2024-2025

Organizer, Food Health and Applied Group Meetings, AgEcon Department, TAMU, 2024

Skills

Software: Stata, R, Python, MATLAB, GAMS, LaTeX

Methods: Demand estimation, discrete-choice models, structural IO, demand systems

Other: LaTeX, openLCA

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)